



Atari 2600

What the Odyssey² was known for was their revolutionary fusion of video games and popular board games of that era: Quest for the Rings!, based on the lines of the popular fiction franchises Dungeons & Dragons and The Lord of the Rings.

1979 was another revolutionary year for gaming consoles. Mattel's electronics division released their Intellivision game console, in response to the Atari 2600. In a move radically different from the others of its generation, and more in sync with the third generation, Intellivision included a unique processor with 10-bit wide instructions, that allowed for more memory addressing, higher processing power and speed. The 10-bit processor was accompanied by 16-bit registers, and an advanced sound chip that promised more clarity, with output from three distinct channels.

The Intellivision performed much better than expected. Sales were off-the-charts by 1982, with more than 2 million consoles sold. Multiple third-party game developers such as Activision and Imagic began releasing titles for the console, which sold almost a million units of the most popular titles. However, because of Atari's exclusive rights to many of the popular arcade games of the time, people preferred the Atari 2600 over the Intellivision, despite the former's inferior graphics, which further helped in cementing the 2600's spot as the top selling console of the time.